

Pixellated Art

Artist Claude Bosset has uploaded a 100 cm x 140 cm painting of a pixel to celebrate the picture element's 50th birthday. It is being auctioned for 500 Euros. Bollywood is making a film on Bosset called 'Hum Aapke Hain Con'.



Booby Trap

An anonymous British scambaiter scammed Nigerian scamster Prince Joe Ebohby convincing him to join the Holy Church of the Order of the Red Breast. Prince painted his nipples red, paying \$80 as fees to the church.



Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar

Escape

PATENT REGIME

Microsoft under your skin

IT biggie Microsoft was recently awarded a patent. Hmmm, so what? Companies such as Microsoft and IBM keep applying for patents, and keep getting them at regular intervals. What's so special about their latest

carry in the near future.

"As a result of carrying multiple portable electronic devices, there is often a significant amount of redundancy in terms of input/output devices included," says the patent application. "For example, a watch, a pager, a PDA and a radio may all include a speaker."

The filing sketches a plan to present a single, uniform interface to these devices. Of course, Microsoft sees these devices with really small form factors with time—so an earring which doubles as a handsfree device could derive power from the earlobe to pick up a call, which your wristwatch (also powered by your skin) has just received.

Such a Personal Area Network (PAN) is currently served by Bluetooth wireless connections, but each

device carries its own LCD screen, batteries, keyboards, etc. Microsoft says it will crunch devices such as MP3 players, PDAs, etc., to make the power source manageable, and the data input method uniform and logical. We are waiting for this one!

GETTING EVEN

An adventure in spam

Got fired? Get your revenge by spamming your bosses. Then get taken in by the cops for all the trouble you caused. A 17-year-old clerk in the UK did just that.

After being asked to leave by UK insurance company Domestic & General for failing to fill in a time sheet, he



ChandigarhCity.com

It advertises itself as a guide to the city of Chandigarh. Which is fine. The Web site however throws a bevy of all-encompassing and vague links such as Art & Culture, Festivals, Religious, etc. burying the visitor under confusion and doubt. The worst of it is the choice of colours employed for a navigation tab: light text over a light background. Way to go!



downloaded a mail bomber and hit his erstwhile employers with five million e-mails. You read that right—five million.

The spam did the job, bringing the insurance company's Web site down and causing a monetary loss amounting to £18,000 (Rs 15 lakh). "All the e-mails were harmless..." he pointed. "I just wanted to cause them a bit of

Illustrations: Farzana Cooper



patent is this: the company has patented a process that makes use of human skin as a pathway to electronic data.

Patent No. 6,754,472 says that the human skin can be used not only as a power source, but also as a data path for innumerable gadgets that we are likely

Win!

My desktop

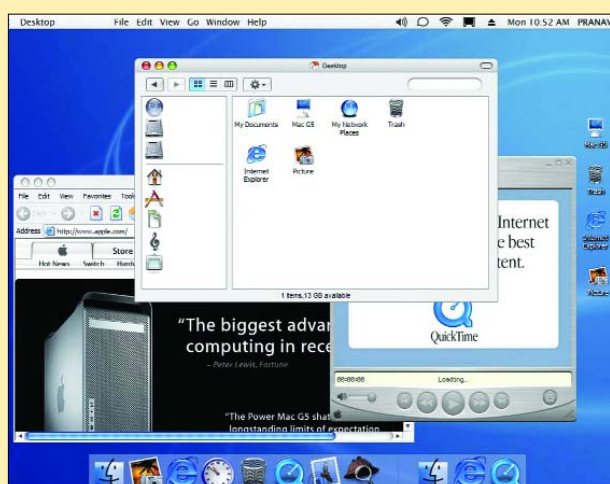
Think you got the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? Send it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit shall publish the most eye-catching of them every month.



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The winning entry will win a cool Webcam worth Rs 1200. This month's winner is Pranav Naik.



The Windows that looks like a Mac: by Pranav Naik